

Carla CISTERNAS

PhD Researcher, Department of Latin American Studies, Institute for History
Faculty of Humanities, Leiden University

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I am a PhD Researcher in the Department of Latin American Studies at the Institute for History at the Faculty of Humanities at Leiden University, Netherlands. I hold an MA (1st) in Political Science from the Institute of Public Affairs at the Universidad de Chile. Moreover, I earned a BA (1st) and a BPS (1st) in Public Administration from the Universidad de Santiago de Chile (USACH).

My doctoral project is supervised by Prof. dr. Patricio Silva and Dr. María Gabriela Palacio and focuses on the relationship between technocracy, democracy, and sociopolitical conflicts. In particular, I study the role of external experts in the design of public policies in Chile between 1990 and 2022. My thesis follows an article-based format, the first of which, titled “**Strategic Use of Ad Hoc Commissions for Blame Avoidance: Evidence from Chile,**” was published in *Public Administration Review*, one of the most prestigious journals in the field of public administration. The Chilean National Agency for Research and Development and the Slicher van Bath de Jong Foundation, through the Centre for Latin American Research and Documentation (CEDLA) of the University of Amsterdam, fund my PhD project.



EDUCATION

- | | |
|--------------|---|
| 2022 - Today | PhD in Politics, Culture and National Identities
Institute for History, Faculty of Humanities
Leiden University |
| 2017 - 2020 | MA in Political Science (1st, First-class honours)
Institute of Public Affairs
Universidad de Chile |
| 2011 - 2016 | BA in Public Administration (1st, First-class honours)
Faculty of Economics and Management
Universidad de Santiago de Chile |
| 2011 - 2016 | Public Service Administrator (1st, First-class honours)
Faculty of Economics and Management
Universidad de Santiago de Chile |



RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

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|----------------------|---|
| Today
Aug 2016 | RGP Associate Editor, UNIVERSIDAD DE VALPARAÍSO, Santiago, Chile <ul style="list-style-type: none">➤ Support the editorial process➤ Manage the Open Journal System (OJS) platform➤ I worked as an Editorial Assistant between 2016 and 2020 |
| Today
Jan 2020 | Coordinator and Research Associate, TRAINING DATA LAB, Santiago, Chile <ul style="list-style-type: none">➤ Coordinate the activities of the research group➤ Working on collaborative research projects |
| Aug 2023
Jan 2021 | Lecturer, UNIVERSIDAD MAYOR, Santiago, Chile <ul style="list-style-type: none">➤ Lecturing at the Faculty of Social Sciences and Arts |
| Dec 2022
Apr 2022 | Research Assistant, CHILEAN NATIONAL AGENCY FOR RESEARCH (GRANT 11201140), Santiago, Chile <ul style="list-style-type: none">➤ Summarise relevant articles on political mediatisation and social networks➤ Elaborate data sets on social media activity➤ Ximena Orchard (Principal Investigator) |
| Aug 2022
Apr 2021 | Predocctoral Fellow, LEIDEN UNIVERSITY, Leiden, Netherlands <ul style="list-style-type: none">➤ Research and preparation of PhD project➤ Prof. Patricio Silva (Supervisor) |

Jan 2022 Apr 2018	Research Assistant, CHILEAN NATIONAL AGENCY FOR RESEARCH (GRANT 1181390), Santiago, Chile ➤ Conduct archive revision on Chilean state-owned companies ➤ Summarise relevant articles on state commercial policies ➤ Elaborate databases based on the archive revision ➤ Diego Barría (Principal Investigator)
Dec 2017 Jul 2016	Research Assistant, CHILEAN NATIONAL AGENCY FOR RESEARCH (GRANT 11140348), Santiago, Chile ➤ Conduct archive revision on Chilean state modernisation ➤ Summarise relevant articles on state modernisation ➤ Elaborate databases based on the archive revision ➤ Diego Barría (Principal Investigator)

PUBLICATIONS

- WoS** Orchard, X., González-Bustamante, B. & **Cisternas, C.** (forthcoming). Amplification, Contestation, and Toxic Interactions with Protest News: How Social Upheaval Reshapes Dynamics between News Organizations and Their Audiences. *Digital Journalism*.
- WoS** **Cisternas, C.** (2026). Strategic Use of Ad Hoc Commissions for Blame Avoidance: Evidence From Chile. *Public Administration Review*, Early View. DOI: [10.18042/cepc/rep.194.09](https://doi.org/10.18042/cepc/rep.194.09)
- ESCI** **Cisternas, C.,** & González-Bustamante, B. (2022). Ciencias sociales en contextos de represión: Análisis bibliométrico de la producción histórica de la Corporación de Estudios para Latinoamérica, Chile (1979-1989). *eCiencias de la Información* 12(2), 1-18. URL: <https://revistas.ucr.ac.cr/index.php/eciencias>. SocArXiv: [10.31235/osf.io/2jrvm](https://doi.org/10.31235/osf.io/2jrvm)
- Scopus** Castañeda, F., Ormazabal, F. & **Cisternas, C.** (2022). Socio-Demographic Determinants of Financial Literacy Levels. *Studies in Business and Economics Journal*, 17(2), 44–61. DOI: [10.2478/sbe-2022-0024](https://doi.org/10.2478/sbe-2022-0024)
- WoS** **Cisternas, C.** (2021). Estrategias de copatrocinio legislativo en la Cámara de Diputados de Chile, 2010-2018. *Revista de Estudios Políticos*, 194, 249-279. DOI: [10.18042/cepc/rep.194.09](https://doi.org/10.18042/cepc/rep.194.09)
- ESCI** Barría, D., González-Bustamante, B., & **Cisternas, C.** (2019). La literatura sobre gobierno abierto en español. Análisis sobre las dinámicas de producción y citación. *Nóesis, Revista de Ciencias Sociales y Humanidades*, 28(56), 22-42. DOI: [10.20983/noesis.2019.2](https://doi.org/10.20983/noesis.2019.2).
- Scopus** **Cisternas, C.,** & Vásquez, J. (2018). Comisiones Asesoras Presidenciales: Entre la expertise y la pluralidad de actores sociales en Chile. *European Review of Latin American and Caribbean Studies*, 106, 1-22. DOI: [10.32992/er-lacs.10349](https://doi.org/10.32992/er-lacs.10349)
- Latindex** González-Bustamante, B., & **Cisternas, C.** (2016). Élités políticas en el poder legislativo chileno: la Cámara de Diputados (1990-2014). *Política, Revista de Ciencia Política*, 54(1), 19-52. URL: <https://revistapolitica.uchile.cl>
- ESCI** **Cisternas, C.** (2016). Espinoza, F. (2015). Bolivia: La Circulación de sus Élités (2006-2014). Santa Cruz de la Sierra: Editorial El País. *Revista de Gestión Pública*, V(1), 143-152. URL: <https://revistas.uv.cl>

WORKING PAPERS

González-Bustamante, B., Verelst, N., & **Cisternas, C.** (2025). Emulating Public Opinion: A Proof-of-Concept of AI-Generated Synthetic Survey Responses for the Chilean Case. *Empiria Lab Method Series*, 1. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.17077751>

González-Bustamante, B., & **Cisternas, C.** (2020). Aplicación de ForceAtlas2, un algoritmo de diseño gráfico continuo, para el estudio de las élites. *Tufte Working Papers*, 1, 1-15. DOI: [10.5281/zenodo.6739266](https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.6739266). SocArXiv: [10.31235/osf.io/gxrkc](https://doi.org/10.31235/osf.io/gxrkc)

Castañeda F., Brown, E., Cloke, J., Gil, F. J., González, M., & **Cisternas, C.** (2020). Social Inclusion: The Higher Education Sector in Chile and in the United Kingdom. *CIRIEC Working Papers*, 9, 1-30. URL: www.ciriec.uliege.be

RESEARCH ASSISTANCE	2020
Military Intervention in Democratic Latin America: The Cases of Argentina and Ecuador in Comparative Perspective María Cristina Escudero (UCHILE) & Jaime Baeza (UCHILE)	
RESEARCH ASSISTANCE	2020
Transitions in the Stock Markets of the US, Brazil and Mexico Francisco Castañeda (UMAYOR)	
RESEARCH ASSISTANCE	2017
Family Ties in the Chilean Chamber of Deputies, 1990-2018 Alfredo Joignant (UDP) & Bastián González-Bustamante (USACH)	
RESEARCH ASSISTANCE	2016
Elite-Mass Congruence in Chile and Uruguay Bastián González-Bustamante (USACH)	
RESEARCH ASSISTANCE	2016
Revolving Door? Analysis of Public-Private Circulation in Chile (2000-2014) Antoine Maillet (UCHILE), Bastián González-Bustamante (USACH) & Alejandro Olivares (UCHILE)	
RESEARCH ASSISTANCE	2016
Undersecretaries Turnover in Chile: An Exploration of the Second Line of Government, 1990-2014 Bastián González-Bustamante (USACH) & Alejandro Olivares (UCHILE)	

SELECTED CONFERENCES

IPSA	Cisternas, C. (2025). <i>Ad Hoc Bodies and the Challenge of Representation in Chilean Governance (1990–2022)</i> . Presentation delivered at the XXVIII World Congress of the Political Science, Seoul, South Korea.
ALACIP	Cisternas, C. (2024). <i>Expertise ad hoc: evidencia de las comisiones asesoras en Chile (1990-2022)</i> . Presentation delivered at the XII Congreso Latinoamericano de Ciencia Política, Portugal, Lisboa.
SLAS	González-Bustamante, B., & Cisternas, C. (2022). <i>Seniority and Cosponsorship in the Chilean Lower House 2006-2018</i> . Presentation delivered at the Society of Latin American Studies Latin America Annual Conference, Bath, UK.
IPSA	Cisternas, C. , & González-Bustamante, B. (2021). <i>Political Careers and Cosponsorship in the Chilean Lower House 2006-2018</i> . Presentation delivered at the XXVI World Congress of the Political Science, Online.
LASA	Cisternas, C. (2019). <i>Producción de leyes y copatrocinio legislativo en la Cámara de Diputados (2010-2018)</i> . Presentation delivered at the XXXVII International Congress of the Latin American Studies Association, Boston, USA.
USACH	González-Bustamante, B., & Cisternas, C. (2018). <i>Social Network Analysis: Application for Elites Study</i> . Presentation delivered at the Symposium of Political-Administrative Elites: Planning a Research Agenda, Santiago, Chile.
ACCP	Cisternas, C. , & Vásquez, J. (2016). <i>El rol de las Comisiones Asesoras Presidenciales (2006-2014)</i> . Presentation delivered at the XII Chilean Congress of Political Science, Pucon, Chile.
CLAD	Barría, D., González-Bustamante, B., & Cisternas, C. (2016). <i>Open Government in Latin America and Spain: Analysis of the Scientific Production in Spanish</i> . Presentation delivered at the XXI CLAD International Congress on the State Reform and Public Administration, Santiago, Chile.
PreALAS	Cisternas, C. , González-Bustamante, B., & Barría, D. (2016). <i>Analysis of the Scientific Production in Spanish on Public Administration and Public Policies (2010-2012)</i> . Presentation delivered at the IX Chilean Congress of Sociology, Talca, Chile.

- PreALAS** González-Bustamante, B., & **Cisternas, C.** (2016). *Co-Authorship Networks of the Political Science in Spanish (2010-2015)*. Presentation delivered at the IX Chilean Congress of Sociology, Talca, Chile.
- UBO** **Cisternas, C.**, & González-Bustamante, B. (2016). *The CIEPLAN Monks: Intellectual Production and Co-Citation Networks During the Eighties*. Presentation delivered at the International Seminar of Social Sciences at the Crossroad: Latin American Intellectuals and Technocrats in Authoritarianism Times, Santiago, Chile



TEACHING EXPERIENCE

- | | |
|----------------------|--|
| Dec 2024
Sep 2023 | Teaching Assistant, LEIDEN UNIVERSITY, Leiden, Netherlands <ul style="list-style-type: none"> ➤ Civil Society and Public Policy |
| Aug 2023
Jan 2021 | Lecturer, UNIVERSIDAD MAYOR, Santiago, Chile <ul style="list-style-type: none"> ➤ Organizational Behaviour and Development ➤ Research Seminar ➤ Machine Learning Applications in Public Policy and Economics |
| Dec 2018
Aug 2018 | Teaching Assistant, UNIVERSIDAD ALBERTO HURTADO, Santiago, Chile <ul style="list-style-type: none"> ➤ Comparative Politics |
| Dec 2017
Mar 2014 | Teaching Assistant, UNIVERSIDAD DE SANTIAGO DE CHILE, Santiago, Chile <ul style="list-style-type: none"> ➤ Research Methodology I ➤ Research Methodology II ➤ Organizational Theory ➤ Organizational Behaviour ➤ Political Science I ➤ Political Science II ➤ Globalisation Theories ➤ History of Political and Administrative Institutions |
| Aug 2016
Mar 2016 | Teaching Assistant, UNIVERSIDAD DE CHILE, Santiago, Chile <ul style="list-style-type: none"> ➤ Study of Political Phenomena |



LANGUAGES

- Spanish (native speaker)
- English (fluent)



SOFTWARES

- R and Python (intermediate)
- Stata and SPSS/PSPP (advanced)
- L^AT_EX and LuaL^AT_EX (intermediate)
- Gephi (advanced)



AWARDS

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|-----------|--|
| 2023 | Research Grant Slicher van Bath de Jong, CEDLA, Universidad de Amsterdam |
| 2022-2026 | Full PhD Scholarship at Leiden University funded by the Chilean National Agency for Research and Development |
| 2020 | Highest rating of the MA in Political Science cohort, Universidad de Chile, Santiago, Chile |
| 2019 | Travel Grant Latin American Studies Association (LASA), Boston, USA |
| 2017-2018 | Full MA Scholarship at the Univ. de Chile funded by the Chilean National Agency for Research and Development |



REFERENCES

Patricio Silva

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María Cristina Escudero

Adjunt Professor, UCHILE

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